OUT OF HELLFIRE

A Dungeons & Dragons 5e adventure

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Out of Hellfire

pulp adventure, camp anni '80

D&D 5e (2014)

Level 3

Duration: one-shot (1-2 sessioni)

Structure: lineare

2026-05-02

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> ⚠ *Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.*

Fuori da Hellfire

Lore

Greyhawkins is a port city where the bizarre is the norm — but nobody expected what happened at the Oakshore docks. A series of murders, corrupted rats everywhere, and behind it all an elf with a too-wide smile and a melody that got inside your head: **Korex**.

The party unmasked him, defeated his rats, and put him to flight. Korex escaped into the sewers beneath the docks — sewers nobody knew existed. The Oakshore Guard doesn't have the resources to pursue him underground. It's up to the party.

Introduction

> *The rain beats down on the Oakshore docks. Sheriff Udo Hutchinson looks at you with a mix of gratitude and impatience. "He escaped into the sewers. The old ones, under the east pier — we didn't even know they were still open." He checks the sword at his hip. "I'm coming with you. Bring him up. Alive or dead, I don't care. Just make sure he doesn't come back."*

The PCs have just finished the fight with the rats. Korex fled through a grate in the floor of the warehouse at the docks. Udo, having just returned to Oakshore from a personal trip, found the district in chaos and has no intention of sending people into the sewers without going himself.

General Plot

- **Act 1 — The Descent**: the PCs enter the sewers pursuing Korex. Dark tunnels, traps left by Korex to slow them down, servants left behind to cover his escape. The environment becomes progressively stranger — the sewers are older and larger than they should be.
- **Act 2 — The Lair**: the PCs reach Korex's hideout. Final confrontation with the bard and his last defenders. Korex can be captured alive (if the PCs resist the charm) or killed.

- **Act 3 — The Discovery**: with the Korex matter resolved, the PCs find the Anello del Virtuoso on his finger — a cursed artifact containing the soul of an ancient bard. Whoever touches it risks putting it on. Whoever wears it gains power, but begins to be possessed. If no PC touches it, a guard puts it on and the problem explodes anyway.

DM Tips

- **Tone**: maintain the camp from the starter kit. Korex is theatrical, the rats are grotesque, the sewers are over-the-top. But the final cliffhanger must have a shift in register — the moment when the comedy stops and the players realize there's something serious going on.
- **Korex in combat**: he doesn't fight fair. He charms, runs, sends servants ahead. If cornered, he begs for mercy — and lies.
- **Capture vs kill**: both options are valid. If captured alive, Korex can provide information (a mix of truth and lies). If killed, the information can be found in his notes in the lair.
- **The cliffhanger**: after the milestone, the Anello del Virtuoso comes into play. The ring was on Korex's finger — it's the source of his power. It contains the soul of an ancient bard who wants to return to life. Three-tier mechanic: passive attraction → touch (WIS save DC 20 or forced wearing) → progressive possession. If no PC touches it, an NPC guard puts it on and attacks. Details in `DiscussioneNarrativa.md`.

Recommended difficulty: 3 PCs at level 3 + Udo Hutchinson + Fin Ditasvelte (NPC companion) **Scalability:** for 4+ PCs, Udo stays behind to watch the entrance and Fin doesn't join (the charm hasn't broken yet). For 2 PCs, keep both companions.

Main NPCs

Full sheets in `characters/`.

- **Udo Hutchinson** — sheriff of Oakshore, veteran. Joins the PCs at the sewer entrance. Party tank.
- **Korex** — CE elf bard, antagonist. Musical charmer, manipulator, coward.
- **Fin Ditasvelte** — CN halfling rogue, formerly charmed by Korex. Emerges from the sewer confused and furious, joins the PCs for revenge. Ring bearer (scenario B).
- **Jason Accordion** — TN human bard, soul within the Anello del Virtuoso. Saga villain.

Charmed thug stat block: see `MON_TeppistaCharmato.md`.

Adventure Structure

#	name	type	file
1	Discesa nelle Fogne	dungeon / exploration	01_DiscesaNelleFogne/DiscesaNelleFogne.md
2	Tana di Korex	dungeon / final encounter	02_TanaDiKorex/TanaDiKorex.md

Future Hooks

- The Anello del Virtuoso → lv4-6 saga: who was the bard in the ring? Race against time to remove it before total possession
- Korex (if captured alive) → source of unreliable information for future adventures
- The ancient sewers → why are they so large? Who built them? The hidden passage in the lair leads deeper
- The bard in the ring has his own plan — he's not an ally

Appendix — Anello del Virtuoso Cheat Sheet

Quick reference for the DM. Full details in `NPC_JasonAccordion.md` and `DiscussioneNarrativa.md`.

Appearance: blackened silver ring, musical ouroboros engraving. It's on Korex's finger.

Activation — 3 Tiers

1. **Attraction** (passive, narrative): when Korex falls, anyone who sees the ring feels curiosity. No roll.
2. **Touch**: whoever touches the ring → WIS save DC 20. Failure = compelled to wear it. Success = manages to set it down, attraction remains.
3. **Worn**: the ring tightens, cannot be removed. Automatic attunement.

Immediate Effects

benefits	drawbacks
+2 to one ability score (by class)	The ring cannot be removed
1 bard spell 1/day without a slot	Nightmares the first night (no long rest)
Advantage on saves against charm	Constant cold in the hand
	Vulnerability to psychic damage

Possession — Grip Tracking

Each use of the 1/day spell → roll **d8**. - **2-8**: it works. - **1**: fails + psychic wave 1d4+grip to everyone within 10 ft + grip +1.

grip	narrative	mechanical
0	Cold, nightmares	Psychic vulnerability
1-2	Jason's tics, rare whispers	Wave 1d4+1/+2
3-4	Jason speaks often, foreign memories	Wave 1d4+3/+4, WIS save DC 14 under stress
5-6	Jason takes control for 1d4 rounds	Wave 1d4+5/+6, WIS save DC 15
7+	Permanent control attempt	Wave 1d4+7+, WIS save DC 16+

Reducing grip: successful WIS save vs Jason (−1), *Lesser Restoration* (−1), *Greater Restoration* (−2).

Removal

Remove Curse loosens the ring for 1d4 hours, then it returns. Permanent removal: find Jason's skeleton + burn it with salt + a wizard who knows the original ritual.

Plan A vs Plan B

- **A** (PC touches): progressive possession of the PC.
- **B variant** (Fin touches): WIS 10, Jason possesses him easily.
- **B base** (nobody touches): guard puts it on → attack → PCs defeat them → the ring remains.

"Free" = new host without defenses, not escape from the ring. Korex knew how to resist it.

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General Map

Key Locations

- **Moli di Oakshore** — starting point, surface. Grate in the east warehouse.
- **Upper sewers** — recent tunnels, damp bricks, ankle-deep water. Korex's traps.
- **Ancient sewers** — wider and older tunnels, carved stone, unknown symbols on the walls. Here the sewers stop looking like sewers.
- **Tana di Korex** — circular chamber carved from an ancient cistern. Improvised hideout with musical instruments, notes, and something that shouldn't be there.

Connections

```
 Moli di Oakshore ---(grate, 4.5m / 15ft / 3qd drop)---> Upper sewers
Upper sewers ---(east tunnel, 20min)---> Ancient sewers
Ancient sewers ---(hidden passage)---> Tana di Korex
```

Geographic Notes

- The upper sewers are linear with a few forks — Korex left traps on the main paths and false clues on the secondary ones.
- The transition between upper and ancient sewers is sharp: bricks give way to older stone, tunnels widen, water disappears.
- Tana di Korex has a single visible entrance. Possible hidden secondary exit (Korex's escape if the PCs are too slow).

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Discesa nelle Fogne

Description

> *The air changes as soon as you descend through the grate. Humidity, darkness, and a sickly-sweet smell that isn't just sewer. Somewhere, far away, you hear an echo — it could be music, it could be running water. Hard to tell.*

The PCs pursue Korex into the sewers beneath the east pier of Oakshore. Brick tunnels, ankle-deep stagnant water, rusty dripping pipes. Korex passed through recently and left traps and false clues to slow them down.

Udo Hutchinson, the sheriff, joins the group at the grate entrance. He doesn't make speeches — he checks his sword and goes down first.

While the group prepares, a halfling stumbles out of the grate: **Fin Ditasvelte**, confused, covered in sewer filth, furious. He had been charmed by Korex at the port — discarded when Korex fled. The charm broke and Fin wants revenge. He knows a bit of the sewer layout because he was down there while charmed, and offers to accompany the group. Full sheet in `NPC_FinDitasvelte.md`.

Dimensions and layout: see DM map in `maps/DiscesaNelleFogne.md`.

Objective

Traverse the sewers following Korex's tracks to the ancient section.

Interior Locations

Entrance Gallery

Straight tunnel, damp bricks, light from the grate that fades after a few steps. On the wall, recent graffiti: a stylized treble clef — Korex's mark. Halfway through the gallery there's a tripwire at ankle height: Perception DC 12 to notice it, Dexterity (thieves' tools) DC 12 to disarm it. If triggered: 1d6 piercing damage from darts in the wall and the rats in the nest are alerted.

The Pipe Junction

The tunnel splits into three. Two branches are dead ends (one flooded, one collapsed). The third continues east. Korex left fake muddy footprints toward the flooded branch — Survival DC 13 to distinguish the real tracks, Investigation DC 14 to notice the fake ones are too regular. The treble clef graffiti on the east wall confirms the right direction.

Rat Nest

An old water collection chamber, large enough for a real fight. The floor is covered in debris: collapsed pipes, raised rusty grates, rubble piles — the rats hide inside and behind them. The entrance is a narrow tunnel that opens into the chamber.

Korex's corrupted rats have taken refuge here. They have red eyes and unnatural behavior (Nature DC 10 to recognize it). They attack anyone who enters.

The cover in the chamber matters: the rats use it to set ambushes, the PCs can use it to protect themselves from the swarm. Collapsed pipes provide half cover, rubble piles are difficult terrain.

Encounter difficulty: EASY (3 PCs lv3 + Udo + Fin)

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Corrupted rat	6	7	12	+4, 1d4+2 bite	Pack Tactics, see `MON_RattoCorrotto.md`
Rat swarm	1	24	10	+2, 2d6 bites	weapon resistance, see `MON_SciameDiRatti.md`

If the gallery trap was triggered, the rats are already alerted and there is no surprise.

The Threshold

The point where the bricks end and ancient stone begins. The tunnel widens, the water disappears, the air becomes dry. On the walls, eroded bas-reliefs: figures dancing or fighting, impossible to tell. History DC 15 to understand that the stone is much older than the city — centuries, perhaps millennia.

> *The walls change under your fingers. No more damp bricks — smooth, cold, carved stone. The tunnel widens. The water is gone. Whatever this place is, it's not a sewer. It never was.*

Key Clues

Korex’s mark on the walls confirms the direction. The fake tracks at the junction show that Korex prepared his escape carefully. The transition to ancient stone is the first seed: these sewers shouldn’t exist. Don’t push it — let the players wonder on their own.

Rewards

No direct rewards. PCs who bypass the traps without triggering them maintain the element of surprise for module 2.

DM Notes

The pace should be tense: the PCs know Korex is escaping. If they spend too much time at the junction, have them hear an echo of music from the right direction — Korex playing in his lair.

Udo doesn’t lead the group but doesn’t stay quiet: he comments on the traps (“That bastard prepared everything”), notices the fake tracks if the PCs don’t find them (“These footprints stink”), and at the threshold he pauses for a moment (“This shouldn’t be here”).

If a PC falls for the trap, the rats in the nest are already alerted — no surprise.

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DM Map — Discesa nelle Fogne

Cheat sheet for drawing the map on the fly at the table. 1 square (qd) = 1.5m / 5ft.

Schematic Layout

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                     │ ALLAGATO │ 2×4qd
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  GRATA                   │
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┌──────────────┐          │                      │   ┌──────────┐
│  GALLERIA    ├──────────┤   BIVIO DEI TUBI     ├───┤ TUNNEL   │
│ D'INGRESSO   │          │    incrocio a T      │   │ VERSO    │
│  6×2 qd      │          │      2qd largo       │   │ NIDO     │
└──────────────┘          └──────────────────────┘   │ 10×2 qd │
                                  │                  └──────────┘
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                          ┌──────────┐                    │
                          │CROLLATO  │                    ┌──────────────────────┐
                          │(vicolo   │ 2×3qd   │     NIDO DI RATTI     │
                          │ cieco)   │ macerie  │       8×8 qd          │
                          └──────────┘                    │  tubi crollati, grate │
                                                          │  macerie (coperture)  │
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                                                              │ TUNNEL VERSO  │
                                                              │ SOGLIA 5×2 qd │
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Quick Measurements

zone	dimensions	notes
Galleria d'ingresso	6×2 qd	light from the grate for the first 2qd
Bivio dei tubi	T-intersection, 2qd wide	three directions: N, S, E
North branch (flooded)	2×4 qd	knee-deep water, dead end
South branch (collapsed)	2×3 qd	rubble, dead end
Tunnel to nest	10×2 qd	continues east from the junction
Nido di ratti	8×8 qd	collapsed pipes, grates, rubble (cover)
Tunnel to threshold	5×2 qd → 3qd	gradually widens
La soglia	3×3 qd	transition bricks → ancient stone

Total linear path: ~30 qd (~45m / ~150ft)

Key Positions — What to Draw Where

Trap (entrance gallery)

- **Where**: 4qd from the entrance (2qd before the end of the gallery)
- **What**: ankle-height tripwire + dart mechanism in the wall
- **Map mark**: a dashed line across the corridor
- Perception DC 12 to spot it, Dexterity DC 12 to disarm it

Clues at the junction

- **North branch**: FALSE muddy footprints toward the water (Survival DC 13)
- **East branch**: real tracks, less obvious
- **South branch**: nothing, just rubble
- Treble clef graffiti (Korex's mark) on the east wall — confirms direction

Nido di ratti

- **6 corrupted rats** scattered in the room, hidden behind debris
- **1 swarm** in the corner opposite the entrance, behind a pile of rubble

- **Cover**: collapsed pipes (half cover, +2 AC), raised grates, rubble piles (difficult terrain)
- The rats use cover to set ambushes; the PCs can use it to protect themselves from the swarm
- If trap triggered: rats already alerted, no surprise

La soglia

- Visible material change: damp bricks → smooth carved stone
- Eroded bas-reliefs on the walls (dancing/fighting figures)
- History DC 15 to understand it's much older than the city

Notes for Drawing on the Fly

1. **Start from the grate** — draw the gallery rectangle, mark the trap with an X
2. **At the junction** make the T — players will choose where to go, only draw the branch they explore
3. **The nest** is the first real room — draw it larger, mark the rat positions
4. **The tunnel to the threshold** widens — show it graphically, it's the signal that something changes
5. **At the threshold** change your stroke if you can (thicker line, different color) to mark the transition
6. Don't draw everything at once — reveal zone by zone as the PCs advance

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Tana di Korex

Description

> *The tunnel opens into a circular chamber, at least six meters high. In the center, a dry cistern turned into an improvised stage: candles, stolen rugs, musical instruments leaning against the walls. And there, sitting on a chair as if he were expecting you, is Korex. The flute at his lips, his fingers moving slowly. He smiles without stopping his playing.*
>
> *"Ah, my favorite fans. Make yourselves comfortable — the show is about to begin."*

Korex's lair is an ancient cistern converted into a hideout. Korex has had time to prepare: he knows the terrain, has placed thugs behind the columns, and has an escape route. Dimensions and layout: see DM map in `maps/TanaDiKorex.md`.

Among the instruments leaning against the walls is a well-crafted lute — stolen loot, not Korex's weapon. The flute is what matters, and Korex has it in hand.

Objective

Capture or kill Korex. Explore the lair after the encounter.

Interior Locations

The Cistern (main arena)

Circular chamber with a raised center (the old cistern) and four columns in a cross pattern. Korex is on the raised area, visible as soon as the PCs enter. Two charmed thugs are hidden behind the east and south columns — Perception DC 14 to notice them before they attack. They reveal themselves on the first round.

The columns provide half cover. The raised area costs 5 ft of extra movement to climb (or Athletics DC 10 to jump up).

Korex’s Alcove

Behind a curtain on the northeast wall: bedroll, scattered notes, a locked chest. Investigation DC 12 to find the useful notes, Arcana DC 14 to decipher Korex’s personal code. The chest contains 120 gp in stolen coins and jewelry.

The Anello del Virtuoso is not here — it’s on Korex’s finger.

The Hidden Passage

Behind a collapsed column to the southeast, a narrow opening that continues into darkness. Korex discovered it while exploring the ancient sewers and keeps it as an escape route. Perception DC 16 during combat, DC 12 after. The tunnel is unmapped — this is where “season 2” begins.

Enemies

Encounter difficulty: HARD (3 PCs lv3 + Udo + Fin)

name	#	HP	AC	attack	notes
Korex	1	52	13	+5, 2d4+3 pierc. + 2d6 poison / Flute 4d6 psy DC 12 WIS	see `NPC_Korex.md`
Charmed thug	2	13	12	+3, 1d6+1 club	see `MON_TeppistaCharmato.md`

Korex’s Tactics

Round 1: attempts to charm the most dangerous PC (or Udo — WIS +0, vulnerable). The thugs emerge from the columns. Rounds 2-3: control spells, keeps his distance, sends thugs forward. If below half HP: begs for mercy, offers information, lies. If the PCs don’t take the bait, attempts to flee toward the hidden passage.

If captured: cooperates in his own way. Mixes truth and lies. Confirms that “someone higher up” gave him the task, but doesn’t know who — sealed letters with an unknown symbol. This is true (Insight DC 15 to recognize it).

The thugs are not evil: if Korex falls, the charm breaks and they surrender confused. If the PCs kill them, Udo points it out.

Key Clues

Korex's notes reveal he wasn't acting alone — someone gave him the power. The Anello del Virtuoso is on his finger: a blackened silver ring with a musical ouroboros engraving, it emanates a subtle attraction when Korex falls. The hidden passage shows that the sewers continue much deeper.

Rewards

- Korex's loot: 120 gp in stolen coins and jewelry
- Lute (quality instrument, non-magical)
- Bounty from the Oakshore Guard: 50 gp (dead) / 75 gp (alive)

Milestone

Level 4 after capturing or defeating Korex.

Finale

Korex captured alive

> *You drag him out of the sewers, hands tied and mouth gagged — you've learned your lesson. Udo takes him into custody with a nod. "Well done."*

The ring is on Korex's finger. Perception DC 10 to notice it (it's conspicuous). It slides off easily — the entity wants to change hosts.

Korex killed

> *The silence in the sewers is almost worse than the music. You bring up the evidence — the notes, the loot, the flute.*

The ring is on the corpse's finger. It loosens on its own. The attraction (Tier 1) is active.

The Cliffhanger — The Anello del Virtuoso

See the ring's operational cheat sheet in `DiscussioneNarrativa.md`.

If a PC touches the ring: WIS save DC 20. Failure → compelled to wear it.

> *The moment the ring slides onto your finger, the world stops for an instant. A warmth rises from the finger, to the arm, to the chest. Then a laugh — low, deep, satisfied — echoes through the sewers. It doesn't come from the ring. It comes from everywhere.*
>
> *"Free. Finally free."*
>
> *The ring tightens. It won't come off anymore. And for an instant — just an instant — you see something in your eyes reflected in a puddle of water. Not your face. Someone else's. Smiling.*

Mechanical effects: +2 to one ability score (see table by class in `NPC_JasonAccordion.md`), advantage on saves against charm. Curse: progressive possession.

If no PC touches it: the ring is handed over to the Guard with the loot.

> *You return to the surface, hand over Korex and the loot. Udo pays you. Everything seems over. But as you walk away from the docks, you hear a scream behind you. You turn around: one of the guards is standing still, motionless, with the ring on her finger. Her eyes are different. She smiles — a smile that isn't hers.*
>
> *"Free! Finally free!"*
>
> *The guard draws her sword.*

In this scenario the PCs fight the possessed guard (fighter with +2 STR, *Heroism*). After defeating her, the ring remains — and the problem with it.

DM Notes

The fight with Korex is the climax. It should feel like a boss fight even though Korex doesn't fight directly — he's a manipulator who charms, runs, and sends others ahead.

The cliffhanger comes after the milestone, when the players feel satisfied. The tonal shift is intentional.

If Korex escapes through the hidden passage, don't pursue him in this adventure — it becomes a hook for season 2.

> ⚠ *Auto-translated from Italian. The Italian version is the source of truth.*

DM Map — Tana di Korex

Cheat sheet for drawing the map on the fly at the table. 1 square (qd) = 1.5m / 5ft.

Schematic Layout

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                          ("stagione 2")
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Legend: - `Cn` `Ce` `Cs` `Cw` = columns (north, east, south, west), ~2qd from center - `└──┘` = cistern platform (3qd Ø platform, 1qd / 1.5m high) - `...` = alcove area + hidden passage (north-east / south-east wall) - Thug 1: behind **east** column (Ce) - Thug 2: behind **south** column (Cs)

Quick Measurements

zone	dimensions	notes
Access tunnel	4×3 qd	from the threshold, enters from the west
Cistern	8qd Ø (~12m)	circular, draw as an octagon
Central platform	3qd Ø, 1qd high	old cistern, Korex is here
Columns	4, in a cross, ~2qd from center	half cover (+2 AC)
Alcova di Korex	3×2 qd	NE wall, behind a curtain
Hidden passage	1qd opening	behind collapsed column SE

Domed ceiling: ~4qd (6m) high.

Key Positions — What to Draw Where

Korex (center)

- **Where**: seated on the central platform, chair + lute
- **What**: visible as soon as the PCs enter — he's theatrical, he's expecting them
- Candles, rugs, musical instruments around the platform

Charmed thugs (east and south columns)

- **Where**: hidden behind Ce and Cs
- **Perception DC 14** to notice them before combat
- They reveal themselves on round 1 — they step out from the columns
- If Korex falls: they surrender, confused (they're not evil)

Alcove (north-east wall)

- **Where**: niche covered by a curtain, only visible when approaching
- **Contents**: bedroll, scattered notes, locked chest
- Investigation DC 12 for useful notes, Arcana DC 14 to decipher the code
- Chest: 120 gp in coins + stolen jewelry
- L'Anello del Virtuoso is NOT here — it's on Korex's finger

Hidden passage (south-east)

- **Where**: behind collapsed column at SE, 1qd opening
- **Perception DC 16** during combat, **DC 12** after
- Korex uses it to escape if below half HP
- The tunnel continues into darkness — not mapped, seed for "season 2"

Combat Tactics — Reminder

round	Korex	thugs
1	Charm on the most dangerous PC	step out from columns, attack
2-3	control spells, keep distance	mace, protect Korex
below 50% HP	begs for mercy, lies, attempts escape toward SE passage	continue or surrender if Korex falls

Terrain

- **Platform**: climbing costs 1 extra qd of movement (or Athletics DC 10 to jump up)
- **Columns**: half cover (+2 AC, advantage on Dexterity saves)
- **Alcove curtain**: can be torn or cut (no roll needed)

Notes for Drawing on the Fly

1. **Draw the octagon** — 8qd diameter, doesn't need to be perfect. A rough circle works fine.
2. **Platform in the center** — smaller circle (~3qd), mark it as raised. Put a K for Korex.
3. **4 columns in a cross** — points ~2qd from center (N, E, S, W). Filled squares.
4. **DON'T draw** the alcove and hidden passage right away — reveal them only when the PCs find them.
5. **After combat**: add the alcove (NE, behind curtain) and, if found, the passage (SE).
6. The entrance tunnel comes from the west — the PCs see Korex straight ahead as they enter.

Appendix — Stat Blocks

Corrupted Rat

Medium humanoid (beast), unaligned

Armor Class 12
Hit Points 7 (2d6)
Speed 30 ft.
Senses darkvision 18m / 60ft / 12qd
Challenge 1/8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
7 (–2)	15 (+2)	11 (+0)	2 (–4)	10 (+0)	4 (–3)

Keen Smell. advantage on Perception checks that rely on smell.

Pack Tactics. advantage on attack rolls if an ally is within 1qd of the target and isn't incapacitated.

Actions

Bite (melee). Attack: +4, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd Damage: 1d4+2 piercing

Swarm of Rats

Medium humanoid (swarm of tiny beasts), unaligned

Armor Class 10
Hit Points 24 (7d8-7)
Speed 30 ft.
Senses darkvision 9m / 30ft / 6qd
Challenge 1/4

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (–1)	11 (+0)	9 (–1)	2 (–4)	10 (+0)	3 (–4)

Keen Smell. advantage on Perception checks that rely on smell.

Swarm. can occupy another creature's space and vice versa. Can move through openings for Tiny creatures. Cannot regain HP or gain temporary HP.

Actions

Bites (melee). Attack: +2, reach 0 Damage: 2d6 piercing (or 1d6 if the swarm has half HP or less)

Charmed Thug

Medium humanoid (human), neutral (charmed, normally not hostile)

Armor Class 12 (leather armor)
Hit Points 13 (2d8+4)
Speed 30 ft.
Languages Common
Challenge 1/8

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Charmed by Korex. the thug is under the effect of charm. If Korex is killed, incapacitated, or flees, the charm breaks at the end of the round. The thug stops fighting, confused.

Actions

Mace (melee). Attack: +3, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd
Damage: 1d6+1 bludgeoning

FinDitasvelte

Medium humanoid (halfling (lightfoot)), chaotic neutral

Armor Class 14 (leather armor)
Hit Points 21
Speed 25 ft.
Senses none special
Languages Common, Halfling, Thieves' Cant
Challenge 2

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (–1)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)

Sneak Attack (2d6). once per turn, extra damage if has advantage or ally adjacent to the target

Cunning Action. Dash, Disengage, or Hide as a bonus action

Fast Hands (Thief). Sleight of Hand, use thieves' tools, or use an object as a bonus action

Second-Story Work. climbing speed equal to movement speed

Actions

Dagger (melee/ranged). Attack: +5, melee or ranged 6m / 20ft / 4qd Damage: 1d4+3 piercing Sneak Attack: +2d6 if has advantage or an ally in melee with the target

Shortbow (ranged). Attack: +5, range 24m / 80ft / 16qd Damage: 1d6+3 piercing

JasonAccordion

Medium humanoid (human (in life), now a trapped soul), neutral evil

Armor Class 12
Hit Points 45 (10d8)
Speed 30 ft.
Skills Perception +2
Senses sight and hearing 36m / 120ft / 24qd (through the wearer)
Languages Common, Elvish, Sylvan, Infernal
Challenge 5

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (–1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)

Sentient Item. Jason exists as a soul in the Ring of the Virtuoso. He has no physical body. He communicates telepathically with the wearer. The stats above represent his mental and magical capabilities, not a body.

Spellcasting (as lv10 bard). spell save DC 16, spell attack +8. Slots: 4/3/3/3/2. Jason can only cast spells through the wearer (when he has control).

Supreme Manipulator. advantage on Deception and Persuasion checks. Creatures that speak with Jason (through the wearer) have disadvantage on saves against his charm spells.

Progressive Possession. see "Progressive possession" section above. Jason doesn't fight directly — he takes control of the wearer.

Actions

Psychic Wave (when a 1 comes up on the d8). Saving throw: none (automatic) Damage: 1d4 + grip level psychic damage Area: all creatures within 15m / 50ft / 10qd of the wearer Effect: hits allies and enemies indiscriminately

Mental Conflict (when Jason forces control). Saving throw: Wisdom DC 14-16+ (varies with grip) Failure: Jason takes control of the wearer for 1d4 rounds (combat) or 1d4 hours (out of combat) Success: the wearer resists, grip decreases by 1

Nightly Nightmares (grip 3+). Damage: 2d6 psychic per night Effect: no benefit from long rest

Korex

Medium humanoid (elf), chaotic evil

Armor Class 13
Hit Points 52
Speed 40 ft.
Skills Perception +3, Performance +4, Stealth +5
Senses darkvision
Languages Common, Elvish, sewer monster languages
Challenge 3

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	8 (–1)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)

Disengage. Korex can disengage as a bonus action

Dash. Korex can use Dash as a bonus action (doubled speed: 24m / 80ft / 16qd)

Poison Immunity. Korex is immune to the poisoned condition and poison damage

Flauto Magico. main weapon. Charm + ranged psychic damage. Devastating against targets with low Wisdom.

Rancid Knife. backup melee weapon. The poison automatically poisons on hit.

Actions

Rancid Knife (melee). Attack: +5, melee Damage: 2d4+3 piercing + 2d6 poison Effect: the target is poisoned until the start of Korex's next turn

Flauto Magico (action). Target: one creature Korex can see within 36m / 120ft / 24qd Saving throw: Wisdom DC 12 Failure: 4d6 psychic damage + charmed until the start of Korex's next turn Success: half damage, no charm

UdoHutchinson

Medium humanoid (human), lawful neutral

Armor Class 14 (scale mail)
Hit Points 58 (9d8+18)
Speed 30 ft.
Languages Common
Challenge 3

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Actions

Multiattack. Udo makes two attacks with the longsword. If he has the shortsword drawn, he can make a third attack with it.

Longsword (melee). Attack: +5, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd Damage: 1d8+3 slashing (or 1d10+3 two-handed)

Shortsword (melee). Attack: +5, reach 1.5m / 5ft / 1qd Damage: 1d6+3 piercing

Heavy Crossbow (ranged). Attack: +3, range 30/120m / 100/400ft Damage: 1d10+1 piercing